

Duolingo

Family Learning Dashboard

Progress visibility and shared goals for Super Family plan owners

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1. Executive Summary

Duolingo's Super Family plan (\$119.99 per year for up to six members) is the company's best value subscription and a meaningful retention lever, yet today it functions as little more than shared billing. The plan owner pays for up to five other people but receives no visibility into whether those members ever open the app, and every member keeps an entirely separate account with no shared goals and no built in encouragement.

The Family Learning Dashboard gives the plan owner an optional, privacy respecting view of household activity (streaks, weekly active minutes, and course progress at a glance), the ability to set one shared household goal, and lightweight encouragement tools. The objective is to convert passive payers into engaged plan managers, lifting member activation and protecting Family plan renewals.

Why now

Family plan friction is a documented weak point: the experience requires one person to carry billing for everyone, and inactive seats represent paid value that never materializes. Members who never activate are the most likely to cancel at renewal, so giving the payer visible proof of value and a social reason to stay directly protects subscription revenue.

2. Problem Statement

User problem

The plan owner (often a parent or the organizer of a friend group) buys the Family plan to help others learn, but has no way to know whether it is working. They cannot tell if their teenager has touched the app, cannot nudge a lapsed member without texting them manually, and cannot rally the household around a common goal. Members, meanwhile, learn in isolation without the accountability that powers Duolingo's core streak loop.

Business problem

At roughly \$20 per member at full capacity, every unfilled or inactive seat erodes the unit economics of Duolingo's highest value subscription and raises cancellation risk. At renewal, the payer has no

evidence the plan delivered value, which makes the Family tier easy to drop. There is currently no product surface that turns a household of separate accounts into a shared, sticky experience.

3. User Personas

Persona	Snapshot	Primary pain point
The Organizer Parent (Maria, 44)	Pays for the family plan so her two teens and her mother can learn languages together.	No visibility; feels like she is paying for something nobody uses.
The Teen Member (Leo, 15)	On his mother's plan, learns in bursts, then forgets the app for weeks.	No accountability and no nudge to come back.
The Friend Group Payer (Devon, 26)	Set up a plan for five roommates to split the cost.	Has to chase people to actually use it; nagging feels awkward.
The Motivated Member (Aisha, 31)	Active daily learner who wants the household learning together.	Learns alone with no shared momentum or visible group progress.

4. Goals and Success Metrics

Qualitative goals

- Give payers visible proof that the Family plan is delivering value.
- Create gentle household accountability that pulls inactive members back.
- Make the Family plan feel like a shared experience rather than parallel solo apps.

Quantitative targets

Metric	Baseline	Target	Measurement
Member seven day activation rate	TBD	+15%	Cohort analysis
Family plan renewal rate	TBD	+8%	Subscription analytics
Weekly active members per family	TBD	+1 member	Engagement logs
Families that set a shared goal	0%	35%	Feature telemetry
Weekly dashboard open rate (owners)	0%	45%	Feature telemetry

- **North Star metric:** weekly active members per paid family seat.

5. Scope

In scope

- An opt in household dashboard for the plan owner.
- Per member streak, weekly active minutes, and current course or unit summary.
- One shared household goal (for example, a collective weekly XP target or everyone keeping a seven day streak).
- In app encouragement: sending a preset cheer or nudge to a member.

- Member privacy controls, consent, and teen safe defaults.

Out of scope

- Parental content controls or lesson restriction.
- Viewing a member's individual lesson answers or mistakes.
- Free form messaging or chat between members beyond preset cheers.
- Any change to billing structure or seat pricing.
- Web parity at launch (mobile first); individual (non family) accounts.

6. Functional Requirements

ID	Requirement	Priority
FR1	Plan owner can view a household dashboard listing each member with current streak, weekly active minutes, and course.	Must Have
FR2	Each member must opt in before any progress data is visible to the plan owner.	Must Have
FR3	Members can revoke sharing at any time from settings.	Must Have
FR4	Teen accounts (ages 13 to 17) default to a privacy safe sharing preset reviewed at setup.	Must Have
FR5	Plan owner can create one shared household goal with a type and timeframe.	Should Have
FR6	Members see the shared goal and collective progress on their home screen.	Should Have
FR7	Plan owner can send a preset encouragement (cheer) delivered as a push notification.	Should Have
FR8	Dashboard shows a household weekly summary card.	Should Have
FR9	Celebratory moment when the household reaches its shared goal.	Nice to Have
FR10	Plan owner can see filled versus empty seats and invite to empty seats from the dashboard.	Nice to Have

7. Non Functional Requirements

- **Privacy:** sharing is strictly opt in; no progress data is exposed without member consent; the dashboard shows summaries only and never lesson content; comply with COPPA considerations for younger teens and applicable regional privacy law.
- **Performance:** dashboard loads in under two seconds on a typical mobile connection.
- **Accessibility:** meets WCAG AA, including screen reader support for every dashboard card.
- **Scalability:** supports the full six member cap with no degradation.
- **Trust:** plain language consent screens; the feature is never framed or designed as surveillance.

8. Risks and Assumptions

Risks

- **Perceived surveillance:** members may feel watched. Mitigate with strict opt in, summary only data, and motivational framing.

- **Family friction:** if positioned as monitoring, it could create tension. Mitigate through encouragement first design.
- **Teen privacy:** younger members are regulator facing. Mitigate with safe defaults and explicit setup review.
- **Low adoption:** the dashboard fails if value to the payer is not immediately obvious at first open.

Assumptions

- A meaningful share of members will consent when sharing is framed as shared motivation.
- Payers genuinely want visibility into whether the plan is being used.
- Shared goals lift engagement, consistent with Duolingo's existing streak and social mechanics.

9. Proposed Timeline

Phase	Focus	Duration
Discovery and research	Interviews with plan owners and members; privacy and legal review.	3 weeks
Design and consent flows	Dashboard UX, consent screens, teen safeguards.	4 weeks
Build (alpha)	Dashboard, consent, and member summary data pipeline.	6 weeks
Beta	Limited rollout to opted in families with shared goals enabled.	4 weeks
GA launch	Phased global rollout with monitoring.	2 weeks

10. Open Questions

- Should the shared goal be set only by the payer, or collaboratively by the household?
- What is the right default sharing state for adult members: off, or prompted at invite?
- Do we surface comparative ranking among members, or does that harm motivation?
- Should cheers be preset only, or allow free text (which adds moderation cost)?
- How do we handle a member who wants zero visibility without making the payer feel a seat was wasted?

11. Appendix

- **Market context:** Super Family is \$119.99 per year for up to six members; Duolingo reported more than 135 million monthly active users in Q3 2025.
- **Related features:** leaderboards, streaks, friend quests, and the existing Family plan management screen.
- **Privacy references:** COPPA and regional consent requirements for minors.
- **Glossary:** plan owner, member, seat, shared goal.